ii. Duty-free import of white/raw sugar was extended up to 30 June 2012; presently the import duty has been fixed at 10 per cent.

2. Administrative Measures

i. Ban on exports of onions was imposed for short periods of time whenever required. Exports of onions were calibrated through the mechanism of minimum export prices (MEP).

ii. Futures trading in rice, *urad, tur,* guar gum and guar seed was suspended.

iii. Exports of edible oils (except coconut oil and forest-based oil) and edible oils in blended consumer packs up to 5 kg with a capacity of 20,000 tons per annum and pulses (except *Kabuli chana* and organic pulses and lentils up to a maximum of 10,000 tonnes per annum) were banned.

iv. Stock limits were imposed from time to time in the case of select essential commodities such as pulses, edible oil, and edible oilseeds and in respect of paddy and rice up to 30 November 2013.

3. Measures to Insulate the Vulnerable Sections

i. The central issue prices (CIP) for rice (at Rs 5.65 per kg for below poverty line [BPL] and Rs 3 per kg for Antodaya Anna Yojana [AAY] families) and wheat (at Rs 4.15 per kg for BPL and Rs 2 per kg for AAY families) have been maintained since 2002.

ii. Under the targeted PDS (TPDS) allocation of foodgrains is being made to 6.52 crore AAY and BPL families at 35 kg per family per month at a highly CIP.

iii. The government has allocated rice and wheat under the Open Market Sales Scheme (OMSS).

iv. The scheme for imports of pulses which envisaged imports for distribution to BPL households through the PDS with a subsidy of Rs 10 per kg operated from November 2008 to June 2012. The government has decided to implement a varied form with a subsidy element of Rs 20 per kg per month for BPL cardholders for the